

Middle East Crisis Update

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A materially bigger and more persistent shock



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Longer Middle East disruption lifts peak prices for oil and gas, lengthens recovery. Infrastructure damage exacerbates the shock. Brent oil now expected to peak at an average \$120/bbl in Q2 and Japanese LNG prices at \$26mmbtu.

Australian CPI inflation now expected to peak at 5.4%yr in June quarter, and even higher on the monthly series, despite the announced cut to fuel excise. Trimmed mean inflation peaks around 4% in 2026 H2. Food prices a particular concern through to 2028, but broader pass-through to non-energy prices also an issue.

RBA now expected to hike rates three times (May, June, August), revised up from one more (in May) previously. Peak cash rate now 4.85%, above previous peak.

Supply shock and tight monetary policy drag on demand, especially consumption and other interest-sensitive sectors. GDP growth forecast to trough at 1%yr in 2027; unemployment rate peaks at 5% end-2026.

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